



Cuil.com

What is Cuil?

Cuil is a search engine that claims to have a database of Web sites three times larger than Google, and ten times larger than MSN. Cuil is Irish for 'wisdom' or strangely enough, 'hazel' and is pronounced as 'cool'. Cuil uses relevance and content to sort the search results instead of popularity metrics, a large component of which is based on the number of inbound links.

Why the hype?

Cuil has positioned itself strongly against Google, attacking the search giant at where it is weakest—the issue of privacy. Cuil claims to analyse the Web, not its users along with the contradictory claims of “size matters” and “organisation is fundamental”. Cuil has no evidence to support its claim of a larger search index.

Where does Cuil stand?

The search index is not really a big factor in determining the overall performance of the search engine. Google has recently claimed to have crawled over a trillion Web pages, although they have not been indexed yet. Moreover, Cuil's column view, and much longer site summaries are nowhere close to the minimalist, clean and simple approach of Google.

Who is in charge?

Not surprisingly, Cuil is managed by many ex-employees of Google. Anna Patterson, Russel Power and Louis Monier are all part of the Cuil team and ex-Google employees. The CEO is Tom Castello—Anna's husband.

How is the response?

Not too good. Cuil takes twice as long to show up less than half as many hits as Google. Moreover, there are many complaints of pornography showing up!



nial sites in India. A niche market for individuals with singular needs was not recognised. While these Web sites had broad categories according to religion or mother tongue, other distinctions were ignored.

While it was possible to look for matches of a particular profession or how fat their pay check was, there were no matrimonial Web sites that only catered to people with a particular need. SimplyMarry.com was a step towards this direction, recognising the fact that marriages in metropolitan areas were different, and the country's first metromonial site was born. This was a step in the direction of things to come.

Now there is a whole ring of super-specialised matrimonial sites, BPOshaadi.com recognises the needs of individuals working in call centres and plays matchmaker for them.

This is godsend for those people, especially

women who work night shifts as this ensures that their partners also have the same shift timings. The work habits are not a problem to the in-laws, and this ensures that both the people in the marriage are living similar lifestyles.

There is also BPOdating.com, which caters to BPO employees who are on the look out for partners, but don't want to marry. Soon to come is Phirviva.com for people into their second marriages, as widows, spinsters and divorcees will understand each other's problems better and relate to the emotional needs. Mangliks.com is a site that lists only mangliks, which has a huge market as 40 per cent of Indians are Mangliks.

Thirtyplussaadi.com is for people between thirty to seventy, and there is a section of featured brides and grooms waiting for marriage.

SpecialShaadi.com is for people with special

needs or abilities, which is proving to be a big help to the parents of such people.

Now there is a space for profiles to be put up which would not be possible on any other matrimonial site.

If you are looking for a match in a person who works for the government, or for matchmaking between government employees, there is GovtShaadi.com.

While the marriages are not as voluminous as the other matrimonial sites, these Web sites have brought together a few couples, and judging from their testimonials, they seem to be really happy with the portals for bringing them together.

All these matrimonial sites also make money from wedding planners, catering, transportation, venues, music, lights and photographers, by charging them a commission for advertising their services, as a convenience, to the users of the sites.■